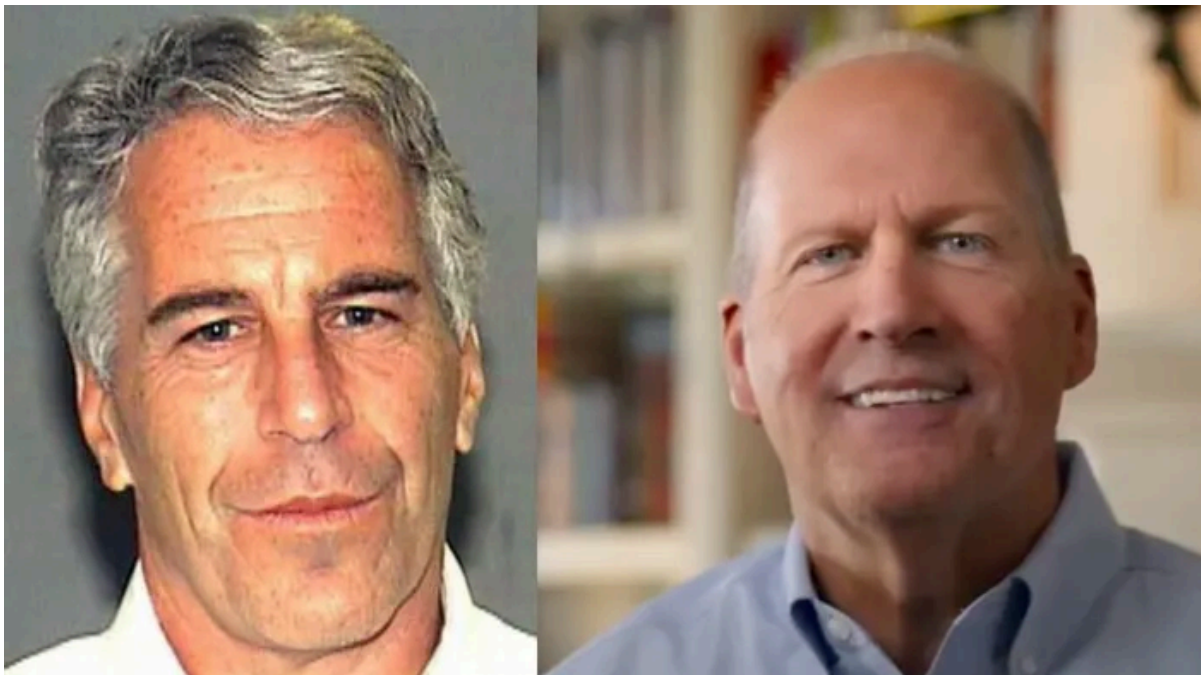




Epstein Told Nikolic to Meet John Sununu in Qatar; Said Sununu 'Has Good Stories'

Sununu denies being in the Epstein files or traveling to Qatar

Troy Matthews • Mar 19, 2026



Republican senate candidate and former New Hampshire congressman John E. Sununu was mentioned by Jeffrey Epstein as a recommendation to his friend and advisor Boris Nikolic for someone to meet up with while visiting Doha, Qatar, because Sununu "has good stories," according to emails in the Epstein files.

Sununu later denied being in the Epstein files or ever having been to Doha, despite travel records showing him going there in 2001 and meeting with a member of the Qatari royal family who was a close friend of Epstein.

In 2010, Nikolic sent an email to Epstein saying he was taking a trip to Doha, Qatar and asked Epstein if there were any interesting people he should meet with while he was

there. Epstein responded with, "you are the most interesting person there..they should be calling me asking me how to meeet[sic] you.,, john sununu, has good stories."

Sununu denied being in the Epstein files and ever having been to Doha, Qatar when asked by a reporter outside the Concord New Hampshire Lincoln Reagan Fundraising Dinner. That exchange was caught on video:

But travel records indicate that Sununu did in fact go to Doha with other members of Congress on a trip paid for by the Islamic Institute to attend a conference with Qatari royal, and then Qatari Foreign Minister, Sheikh Hamad bin Jasem bin Jabir Al-Thani. Records indicate Sununu was in Doha from April 7th to April 11th, 2001.

Hamad bin Jasem later became the Qatari Prime Minister. He had an extensive friendship with Epstein that lasted for years. The two were seen together on multiple occasions from at least 2015. Epstein referred to him as "HBJ" in texts and emails. A text conversation between Epstein and Steve Bannon from April 2018, where Epstein was

working on introducing Bannon to Hamad bin Jasem, revealed that Epstein had been to his house in the South of France:

EPSTEIN: HBJ. Dates? May 2,3

BANNON: In Europe right now may change

EPSTEIN: Yes. He wanted to meet you in south of France. He has a amazing, house there, I will organize to have you picked up. Once you confirm. , we can discuss more thurs

[Department Of Justice, Epstein Library, "HBJ", [4/23/18](#)]

Bannon also suggested that Hamad bin Jasem and Epstein were neighbors in New York in another text thread:

EPSTEIN: HBJ in article

BANNON: What article?

EPSTEIN: Nytimes i sent you the headline

BANNON: Yes just read

EPSTEIN: Can you imagine him in front of shiff committee

BANNON: Can u imagine HBJ in front of a committee

EPSTEIN: am I think our exact same messages crossed ;)

BANNON: Barrack or HBJ!-- he should not take occupancy of his new digs across the street from you for a while

[Department Of Justice, Epstein Library, "HBJ", [12/14/18](#)]

Epstein also had a framed photo of himself and what appears to be Hamad bin Jasem on his desk:

John Sununu claims he is not mentioned in the Epstein files and never went to Doha, Qatar, but travel records confirm that Sununu traveled to Doha as part of a Congressional delegation to meet Hamad bin Jasem who was then the Qatari Foreign Minister.

Sununu then apparently became so connected in Qatar, and was in Doha so often, that in 2010 Epstein recommended to his friend Boris Nikolic to seek him out while he was visiting Doha, because Sununu had "good stories."

Around that period and for the rest of his life, Epstein was close with Hamad bin Jasem, who became the Qatari Prime Minister.

Epstein was apparently connected in Qatar along with Sununu, and the two shared a link to Hamad bin Jasem. But Sununu denies being mentioned in the Epstein files or ever having been to Doha.

In February 2025, Sununu's campaign was asked about his name being mentioned in the Epstein email and stated, "This is a complete fabrication by someone proven to be a compulsive liar."

Sununu is running for U.S. Senate from New Hampshire in 2026.